



AFTER

The success of Federal forces in the Carolinas and Alabama effectively thwarted Confederate hopes of a second line of defense if Richmond fell.

THE TIGHTENING NOOSE

The setbacks in the South increased the **pressure on Robert E. Lee's army** defending Petersburg, which increasingly came to be seen as the **last point of resistance** to a Union victory. The Union advance in the Carolinas had cut Lee off from the sea, leaving him increasingly reliant on a handful of westbound roads and railroad lines for all his supplies.

EBBING HOPES

News of Union incursions also had **a devastating effect on the morale** of Confederate soldiers. Many came from areas affected by the fighting, leading to an **upsurge in desertions** among men desperate to return home to check on their families' fate.

JOHNSTON'S SURRENDER

Confederate general **Joseph Johnston finally surrendered** to William T. Sherman on April 26 (see [Last Terms of Surrender](#)), 17 days after General Lee's [surrender at Appomattox Court House](#). The Battle of Palmito Ranch, Texas, on May 19, was the war's last battle.